

To push Apple's claim further, I ran a 1080p video loop test, and the Air tapped out at 20 hours and 59 minutes. It's impressive for its size, but still short of Apple's advertised figure, proving that efficiency is doing a lot of the heavy lifting here, not sheer battery size.

There's also the matter of charging. The phone takes about an hour and a half to go from flat to full, which isn't slow by Apple standards but lags behind what some Android thin-and-light rivals manage. MagSafe is limited to 20W instead of the 25W speeds the rest of the iPhone 17 lineup gets, and wired charging caps out at 50 percent in around half an hour.

Apple released a companion MagSafe battery pack for the Air, carrying the same 3,149 mAh capacity. On paper, it doubles your usage. In practice, it makes the thinnest iPhone thick again, which feels like missing the point.

CAMERAS

Apple took a very un-2025 approach with the iPhone Air's cameras and for good reason. The Air doesn't pretend to be a camera-first phone. You get one 48MP main sensor with OIS, plus an 18MP selfie camera with a new square sensor, PDAF and OIS. That's it.

In daylight, the main camera delivers sharp, natural images with excellent colour balance. Reds don't bleed, greens retain depth, and objects pop against backgrounds without artificial contrast boosts. Detail holds up well even in close focus, where textures like fabric or foliage remain crisp instead of smudging under noise reduction. The sensor-shift stabilisation helps keep shots steady, even when you're just pointing and firing without much effort.

Dynamic range is handled with restraint. Bright skies stay intact without blowing out, while shaded areas hold enough detail. Unlike some phones that overcompensate with HDR and flatten everything, the Air's processing keeps a natural separation between highlights and shadows. It doesn't try too hard, and that works in its favour.



Background blur, both natural and portrait-mode assisted, looks clean and convincing. Fine strands of grass or edges of objects are separated with confidence, and the blur roll-off feels smooth rather than cut-out.

The selfie camera, with its wider field of view and stabilised lens, is more versatile than older iPhones. It captures sharp, balanced skin tones and holds exposure even in tricky backlit conditions. Apple's new sensor and framing features help keep subjects centred without the awkward stretching you sometimes see on ultrawide selfies.

Low light is where you start to see the Air's limitations. It can brighten a scene and keep colours accurate, but fine details soften and noise control gets more aggressive than on the Pro models. For most casual snaps, it's still good enough and video is still where Apple leads the conversation.

VERDICT

At 1,19,900, the iPhone Air isn't the phone everyone should buy, but it might be the phone you want. It doesn't have the stamina or the camera versatility

of the Pro, or the charging speeds of cheaper Androids. What it does have is a sense of wonder.

Living with the Air means accepting trade-offs. None of that kills the magic of a phone that feels impossibly thin, light, and powerful enough for everything most people do day to day.

So where does that leave it? Somewhere in between genius and indulgence. For anyone who adored the iPhone 4 as a futuristic artefact, the iPhone Air blends nostalgia and tomorrow in one razor-thin slab. It may not be the smartest choice, but its emotional pull outshines any checklist.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Apple A19 Pro | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage 256GB, 512GB, 1TB | OS: iOS 26 | Display: 6.5-inch all-screen OLED HDR display, 2736 x 1260 pixels | Refresh Rate: 1-120 Hz | IP Rating: IP68 | Cameras: 48 MP Fusion | Selfie Camera: 18 MP Centre Stage | Video: Up to 4K at 60 fps | Battery Capacity: 3,149 mAh

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